

HANZHONG SUN (He/Him/His)

PhD Candidate, Second Language Studies, Educational Studies Program
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EDUCATION

2027 Spring (expected)	University of Cincinnati PhD, Second Language Studies (cumulative GPA: 4.0/4.0 , 96 credit hours earned) Dissertation: <i>When Second Language Learners Meet English Epicene Pronouns: Use, Perception, and Learning</i> (tentative title) Committee: Drs. Hye K. Pae (Chair), Evthokia Saclarides, and Mark Sulzer
2026 Fall (expected)	University of Cincinnati MA, Educational Psychology and Child Studies (cumulative GPA: 4.0/4.0) Thesis: <i>TBD</i>
2017	South China Normal University, Guangzhou, China MA, Linguistics and Applied Linguistics
2014	Ningbo University, Ningbo, China BA, in English Language and Literature

NON-DEGREE EDUCATION

2026 Fall (expected)	University of Cincinnati Graduate Certificate, Teaching English to Speakers of Other Languages (TESOL)
2026 Summer (expected)	University of Birmingham Certificate, Corpus Linguistic Summer School 2026
2026 Summer (expected)	The Education University of Hong Kong Certificate, Academic Summer Institute on Language Education Ecological Languageing: Linguistics for the Real World

PROFESSIONAL POSITIONS

2025 - 2026	University of Cincinnati, Ohio, United States (10 hrs/wk) Instructor of Record, the Center for English as a Second Language
2025 - 2026	University of Cincinnati (10 hrs/wk) Graduate Research Assistant, Learning by Design Lab <i>Assisted with data entry, coding, and analysis for a preschooler literacy development project</i>
2025 Summer	University of Cincinnati (80 hrs) Graduate Teaching Assistant, School of Education
2023 - 2025	University of Cincinnati (20 hrs/wk) Graduate Research Assistant, Evaluation Services Center

Assisted a team of research associates in performing tasks in various projects spanning the areas of education, public health and human services

- *Managed datasets, e.g., entering, analyzing & coding data*
- *Created tables and graphs using Excel and RStudio*
- *Searched and reviewed literature*
- *Designed conference slides and posters*
- *Reviewed and checked final project reports*
- *Performed other project-related tasks*

2020 - 2023	Quzhou University, Quzhou, China Lecturer, College English Department
2020 - 2022	Quzhou University Associate Director, College English Department
2017 - 2019	Quzhou University Assistant Lecturer, College English Department
2017 - 2019	Quzhou University Research Secretary, School of Foreign Languages
2015 - 2016	South China Normal University Teaching Assistant, School of Foreign Studies

AERAS OF SPECIALIZATION

- Broad areas: (instructed) second language acquisition, psycholinguistics, applied linguistics, English for academic purposes
- Specific topics: vocabulary use, learning, teaching, and processing; epicene pronouns (use, perception, learning, teaching, and processing); academic writing (emotion, genre analysis, and meta-discourse analysis); generative AI in second language education

PUBLICATIONS

Note: SSCI = Social Sciences Citation Index; A&HCI = Arts & Humanities Citation Index; SCI = Sciences Citation Index; ESCI = Emerging Sources Citation Index; IF = impact factor

Peer-Reviewed Journal Research Articles

- Pae, H.K., Xia, D., **Sun, H.**, Chen, Y., ...Sedaghat, A.R. (53 authors) (2026) Translation and cross-cultural adaptation of the Chronic Rhinosinusitis Control Test for global use. *International Forum of Allergy & Rhinology*. (SCI Q1, IF = 6.8)
- Xia, D., Chen, Y., **Sun, H.**, Pae, H.K. (2026). Both quantity and quality matter: Investigating the presence and effectiveness of key argumentative elements in students' persuasive writing. *International Journal of Applied Linguistics*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1111/ijal.70174> (SSCI Q1, IF = 1.7; A&HCI; Scopus Q1)
- Sun, H.**, Fang, S., & Pae, H. K. (2026). Chinese EFL learners' use of English synonyms: A mixed methods study. *International Journal of TESOL Studies*. 8(3), 29–47. <https://doi.org/10.58304/ijts.250524> (Scopus Q1)
- Sun, H.**, Luo, X., & Pae, H.K. (2026). "A student is working on *their* own project": A systematic review of epicene singular *they* by learners of English. *SN Social Sciences*, 6, Article 60.

<https://doi.org/10.1007/s43545-026-01312-z> (Scopus Q2)

Sun, H., Cheng, W., Pae, H. K., & Wang, L. (2025). Gender bias in Chinese EFL writing: A corpus-based study of epicene pronouns. *Linguistics and Education*, 89, Article 101464.

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.linged.2025.101464> (SSCI Q1, IF = 2.1; A&HCI; Scopus Q1)

Sun, H., Luo, X., & Pae, H. K. (2025). Changing gendered language in English academic writing? Epicene pronoun usage in learners' research manuscripts and gender-inclusive practices in journal guidelines. *Changing English: Studies in Culture and Education*, 32(3), 325–339.

<https://doi.org/10.1080/1358684X.2025.2477999> (ESCI; Scopus Q1)

Sun, H., & Pae, H. K. (2025). Never judge a person by *his*, *his or her*, or *their* appearance: Spotlighting the use of gender-neutral pronouns among learners of English. *The Journal of Asia TEFL*, 22(1), 113–122. <https://doi.org/10.18823/asiatefl.2025.22.1.7.113> (Scopus Q2)

Sun, H., & Fang, S. (2022). Paired-associate second language vocabulary learning: The role of L1 translation familiarity. *The Journal of Asia TEFL*, 19(1), 50–65. (Scopus Q2)

<http://doi.org/10.18823/asiatefl.2022.19.1.4.50>

Sun, H., & Fang, S. (2021). What constitutes vocabulary learning difficulty? A classroom-based study of semantic relatedness and L1 familiarity effects on L2 word learning. *Australian Journal of Applied Linguistics*, 4(3), 82–102. <https://doi.org/10.29140/ajal.v4n3.545>

Sun, H. (2020). Is L2 exposure always a strong modulator of L1 influence? Evidence from Chinese EFL learners acquiring English collocations. *International Journal of English Linguistics*, 10(5), 23–38.

<https://doi.org/10.5539/ijel.v10n5p23>

Peer-Reviewed Book Chapters

Pae, H. K., Xia, D., **Sun, H.**, & Allen, E. (2026). BE-yond orthographic simplicity: A corpus-based analysis of copula BE overuse in ESL writing by native Chinese speakers. In T. Liu, M. Chen, & Y. Tono (Eds.). *Corpus linguistics in Asian contexts*. Springer.

Pae, H. K., Tian, L., Xia, D., & **Sun, H.** (2026). Educational equity and efficacy: Addressing academic standards in and through project-based learning and teaching. In G. H. Beckett & H. K. Pae (Eds.). *Project-based learning in language and content teacher education: Interdisciplinary and multimodal perspectives* (pp. 19–36). Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003636588-3>

Pae, H. K., **Sun, H.**, & Babu, M. (2026). The role of syllables in Korean word recognition and reading: A meta-analysis. In H. Wiskel & H. K. Pae (Eds.). *Handbook of nonlinear writing system—Complex processes and learning challenges*. Springer.

Pae, H. K., & **Sun, H.** (2025). Beyond script universality: A meta-analysis of transposition effects on visual word recognition in Hangul. In H. K. Pae, H. Wiskel, & S. Y. Kim (Eds.). *Handbook on the Korean language and literacy: Insights into Hangul and text processing* (pp. 211–235). Springer.

https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-88087-2_11

Report

Glueckert, K., Holton, J., **Sun, H.**, & Schutzman, C. (2024, September). *ARP ESSER Extended Learning and Recovery: Phase 2 Analysis Report*. Cincinnati, Ohio: Evaluation Services Center, University of Cincinnati.

Book Reviews

- Sun, H.,** Pae, H. K., & Tian, L. (2026). Adaptable English language teaching: Advances and frameworks for responding to new circumstances. *ELT Journal*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1093/elt/ccag018> (SSCI Q1; A&HCI)
- Sun, H.,** Fang, S., & Pae, H. K. (2026). Doing vocabulary research. *Applied Linguistics*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1093/applin/amag028> (SSCI Q1)
- Sun, H.,** & Pae, H. K. (2025). Corpora, collocation, and language learning. *The Journal of Asia TEFL*, 22(1), 199–202. <https://doi.org/10.18823/asiatefl.2025.22.1.16.199> (ESCI; Scopus Q2)
- Sun, H.,** & Pae, H. K. (2024). Creativity in second language acquisition. *System*, 123, Article 103315. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.system.2024.103315> (SSCI Q1)
- Sun, H.,** & Pae, H. K. (2024). English L2 vocabulary learning and teaching: Concepts, principles, and pedagogy. *TESOL Journal*, 15(4), Article e804. <https://doi.org/10.1002/tesj.804> (ESCI; Scopus Q1)
- Sun, H.,** Fang, S., & Pae, H. K. (2023). Research methods in vocabulary studies. *The Social Science Journal*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1080/03623319.2023.2278281> (SSCI Q2)
- Sun, H.,** & Pae, H. K. (2023). Vocabulary in the foreign language curriculum: Principles for effective instruction. *System*, 115, Article 103060. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.system.2023.103060> (SSCI Q1)
- Sun, H.,** Fang, S., & Pae, H. K. (2022). Cross-linguistic influence and second language learning. *System*, 110, Article 102927. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.system.2022.102927> (SSCI Q1)

RESEARCH GRANTS

Funded Research Grants

[1] CECH 2025-2026 Graduate Student and Faculty Mentoring Grant (1,000 USD, in progress, student PI; collaborating faculty PI: Dr. Hye K. Pae, top-ranked proposal)

[2] The University of Cincinnati's Graduate College and Office of Research 2025-2026 University Research Council (URC) Graduate Student Stipend and Research Cost Program for Faculty-Student Collaboration (8,500 USD, in progress, student PI; collaborating faculty PI: Dr. Hye K. Pae)
Note: The University of Cincinnati's oldest and most prestigious internal funding mechanism

[3] CECH 2024-2025 Graduate Student and Faculty Mentoring Grant (2,000 USD, in progress, student PI; collaborating faculty PI: Dr. Hye K. Pae, top-ranked proposal)

[4] CECH 2023-2024 Graduate Student and Faculty Mentoring Grant (1,000 USD, completed, student PI; collaborating faculty PI: Dr. Hye K. Pae)

[5] University-Level Teaching Reform Project of Quzhou University, 2019 (5,000 CNY, completed, faculty PI)
Title: *Study of Teacher Interactional Competence in College English Class: A Systemic Functional Linguistics Informed Approach*

[6] Zhejiang Provincial Education Science Research Project, 2018 (2,000 CNY, completed, faculty PI)
Title: *The Semantic Knowledge Acquisition of English Synonyms among Chinese EFL Students*

Grant Applications Submitted but Not Selected for Fundings

- [1] 2026 Dean's Dissertation Completion Fellowship (one of the two nominations made by the School of Education)

AWARDS (selected)

- [1] Evelyn Wenzel Memorial Scholarship Fund (Graduate), CECH, University of Cincinnati, 2026-2027 academic year (\$1,000)
- [2] "Be the Change" Scholarship, CECH, University of Cincinnati, 2026-2027 academic year (\$1,000)
- [3] Graduate Student Conference Travel Award, University of Cincinnati, 2024 (\$2,200), 2025 (\$1,800)
- [4] Ohio TESOL Conference Full-Time Student Grant Award, 2024 (\$90)
- [5] National Scholarship for Graduate Students, Ministry of Education, China, 2016 (¥20,000)
- [6] Outstanding Graduate Student, South China Normal University, China, 2016 (¥2,000)
- [7] First Class Scholarship, Graduate School, South China Normal University, China, 2016 (¥10,000), 2015 (¥10,000)
- [8] Second Class Scholarship, Graduate School, South China Normal University, China, 2014 (¥8,000)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (*presenter if multiple authors)

- *Xia, D., Chen, Y., **Sun, H.**, Pae, H.K. (2026). Both quantity and quality matter: Investigating the presence and effectiveness of key argumentative elements in students' persuasive writing. Symposium on Second Language Writing, Kyoto, Japan [Paper presentation] (10/23-10/25/2026)
- *Pae, H. K., **Sun, H.**, Xia, D., & *Beckett, G. H. The efficacy of generative AI on students' performance in K-12 and higher education: A meta-analysis. American Educational Research Association (AERA), Los Angeles, California, the United States [Poster presentation] (4/8-4/12/2026)
- ***Sun, H.**, Xia, D., & Pae, H. K. Stance and affect in doctoral dissertation examiner reports: A cross-disciplinary corpus-based study. The Spring Research Conference, Cincinnati, Ohio, the United States [Paper presentation] (3/28/2026)
- *Van, A., ***Sun, H.**, & Pae, H.K. Does GenAI really write like us? A systematic review of linguistic comparisons between GenAI and human texts. The Spring Research Conference, Cincinnati, Ohio, the United States [Paper presentation] (3/28/2026)
- Charles-Carlin, M., Adkins, R., Marcoux, J., Nie, E., Sullivan, E., **Sun, H.**, Van, A., Wall, M.C., & Raider-Roth, M. Exploring teaching-learning relationships in higher education. The Spring Research Conference, Cincinnati, Ohio, the United States [Paper presentation] (3/28/2026)
- ***Sun, H.**, Cheng, W., Pae, H. K., & Wang, L. Generic *he* or singular *they*? Epicene pronoun usage by Chinese EFL learners and ChatGPT. American Association for Applied Linguistics (AAAL), Chicago, Illinois, the United States [Paper presentation] (3/21-3/24/2026)
- *Pae, H. K., & **Sun, H.** Syllabic configuration and its robust impact on lexical processing in Korean: Evidence from a meta-analysis. Association for Reading and Writing in Asia (ARWA), Kaohsiung City, Taiwan, China [Paper presentation] (3/5-3/6/2026)
- ***Sun, H.**, Luo, X., & Pae, H. Examining second language Learners' use of epicene pronouns in research manuscripts and gender-inclusive practices in journal guidelines. Purdue Linguistics Symposium, West Lafayette, Indiana, the United States [Paper presentation] (accepted but unable to attend, 4/11-4/12, 2025)
- ***Sun, H.**, Pae, H. K., & Luo, X. The effect of semantic relatedness on second language vocabulary learning: A systematic review. The Spring Research Conference, Lexington, Kentucky, the United States [Paper presentation] (3/29/2025)
- ***Sun, H.**, Cheng, W., Pae, H. K., & Wang, L. Gender diversity expressed in Chinese EFL learners' writing: A corpus-based study of epicene pronouns. American Association for Applied Linguistics (AAAL), Denver, Colorado, the United States [Paper presentation] (3/22-3/25/2025)

- *Sun, H., & Pae, H. K. Never judge a person by *his* appearance: Spotlighting English learners' use of gender-neutral pronouns. Ohio TESOL Conference, Columbus, Ohio, the United States [Paper presentation] (11/21-11/22/2024)
- *Glueckert, K., Holton, J., Schutzman, C., & Sun, H. Learning recovery: Preliminary case study overview. Ohio Evaluation Services Center Program Cabinet, Ohio, the United States [Invited talk] (4/4/2024)
- Sun, H. What predicts second language lexical recognition behavior? A proposal. The 6th Forum of Applied Linguistics at Guangdong University of Foreign Studies, Guangzhou, China [Paper presentation] (2021)
- Sun, H. Syntactic or semantic? Pinning down the source of difficulty in acquiring English synonyms by Chinese EFL learners across two proficiency levels. Foreign Language Talents Training Conference, Quzhou, Zhejiang, China [Paper presentation] (2021)
- Sun, H. Paired-associate second language vocabulary learning: The role of L1 translation familiarity. The 3rd National Conference on Instructed Second Language Acquisition, Wuhan, Hubei, China [Paper presentation] (2021) (selected as *Excellent Paper*)
- Sun, H. Exploring the role of semantic relatedness and L1 familiarity in L2 word learning. The 4th National Forum on Educational Linguistics, Ningbo, Zhejiang, China [Paper presentation] (2019)
- Sun, H. The influence of semantic relatedness and L1 translation familiarity on L2 word learning. The International Symposium on the Cognitive Neural Mechanism of Language, Qufu, Shandong, China [Paper presentation] (2018)
- *Sun, H. & Chen, Z. L1 transfer effect on the acquisition of L2 collocations. The 4th Forum of Applied Linguistics at Guangdong University of Foreign Studies, Guangzhou, Guangdong, China [Paper presentation] (2016)
- *Sun, H. & Chen, Z. A corpus-based comparative study of high-frequency verb HOLD. The 3rd Guangdong Postgraduate Academic Forum of Language and Literature, Guangzhou, Guangdong, China [Paper presentation] (2016) (second-prize winner)

COURSES TAUGHT

University of Cincinnati

- Teaching Assistant
LSLS 7060 *Applied Linguistics* (2025 Summer; asynchronous online; graduate level; 31 students)
- Instructor of Record
ESL 1069 Success in Academic Reading and Writing (2026 Spring; asynchronous online; undergraduate level; 10 students)

Quzhou University

- Instructor of Record
English Intensive Reading (2017 Fall to 2023 Spring)
IELTS Preparation (2018 Fall)
English Practical Writing (2020 Fall; 2021 Fall)
English Academic Writing (2023 Spring)
Introduction to Linguistics (2021 Fall; 2022 Spring)

South China Normal University

- Instructor of Record
English Intensive Reading (2015 Fall)

COMMUNITY SERVICE

The WCPO 9 Scripps Regional Spelling Bee Competition Volunteer, Cincinnati Public Schools headquarters, Cincinnati, Ohio, United States, 3/7/2026
Panel of Professional Development (*Research Academic Research Efficiently*), School of Education, University of Cincinnati, Cincinnati, Ohio, United States, 11/12/2025
Professional Development Planning Committee, School of Education, University of Cincinnati, Cincinnati, Ohio, United States, 2025 Fall and 2026 Spring

- Attending monthly committee meetings to discuss professional development opportunities
- Planning two one-hour sessions for doctoral students at the School of Education

Student Panel, Graduate Student Orientation at the School of Education, University of Cincinnati, Cincinnati, Ohio, United States, 8/27/2025
Move-in Volunteer for first-year undergraduates, Division of Student Affairs, University of Cincinnati, Cincinnati, Ohio, United States, 8/20/2025
Reception Desk Volunteer, American Association for Applied Linguistics (AAAL) Conference, Denver, Colorado, United States, 3/21/2025
Pre-conference Volunteer, Ohio TESOL Conference, Columbus, Ohio, United States, 11/20/2024

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Conference Proposal Reviewer

Second Language Research Forum (SLRF), 2025 (5 proposals) and 2026 (3 proposals)
British Educational Research Association (BERA) Conference, 2025 (20 proposals)

Journal Manuscript Reviewer

Discover Artificial Intelligence (Springer, 2026)
Discover Psychology (Springer, 2025, 2026)
International Journal of Learner Corpus Research (John Benjamins, 2025)
Forum for Education Studies (Academic Publishing, 2025)
International Journal of Applied Linguistics (Wiley, with Dr. Hye Pae, 2023)

Book Chapter Reviewer

Springer (2024)

CERTIFICATE

Ohio Literacy Library, Multilingual Learners Certificates: 10 Learning Modules (2025)
Senior High School English Teacher Qualification Certificate (China, 2017)
Higher Education English Teacher Qualification Certificate (China, 2018)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

American Association for Applied Linguistics (AAAL, 2024-present)
Asia Teaching English as a Foreign Language (TEFL, 2024-present)
Ohio Teaching English to Speakers of Other Languages (Ohio TESOL, 2024-present)
The International TESOL Union (ITU, 2025-present)
Association for Reading and Writing in Asia (ARWA, 2025-present)
Association for Diversity in Linguistics (2025-present)

LANGUAGES

Mandarin Chinese (native)
Wu Dialect, Shanghai-ese (native)
English (fluent)
French (beginner)

Updated: 5/18/2026